

Business requirements document (BRD)

Describe what the business needs from the data product, in business language. The data team turns your answers into a design, then explains that design back to you in plain words for your signature before anything is built.

Use the BRD or the PRD (4b), not both. They feed the design in the same way.

Use case
Define 1 · Describe it

Scorecard
Define 2 · Score it

Prioritisation
Define 3 · Choose

BRD or PRD
Define 4 · Require it

TDD
Design · Next stage

Worked example. This is BRD-SALES-002@1.2.0, read from the BRD record in the repository. Only the use-case link is added for the example.

BRD ID
BRD-SALES-002

DATA PRODUCT
Sales Performance

BUSINESS OWNER
Sales Operations

DATA STEWARD
Data Analytics

BUSINESS DOMAIN
Sales

USE CASE **ILLUSTRATIVE**
UC-SALES-001

VERSION
1.2.0

DATE
-

STATUS
☐ Draft ☐ In review ☒ Approved

Change history

Version	What changed	Raised by	Accepted by
1.2.0	Acceptance scenarios added for every requirement (AX-7 to AX-14). R-4 extended to region, answering the history question for region (HB-3). R-10 title corrected to match its body. Residency stated as a jurisdiction rather than an infrastructure region.	framework review (2026-10)	sales-operations
1.1.0	R-10 freshness relaxed from 15 minutes to hourly following the design feasibility pass. The source database cannot currently be read continuously without network connectivity work. Business accepted hourly; the shorter interval remains achievable later without redesign.	design feasibility pass (TDD-SALES-002)	sales-operations
1.0.0	Initial approved version.		

1 Purpose

Why does the business need this? Who benefits, and what will they do differently?

Sales leadership needs to understand which parts of the business are growing, measured consistently with how Finance reports revenue and how Merchandising defines the product range.

2 Business questions

What questions must this answer, who needs the answers, and which decision does each answer support?

ID	Question	Decision it supports	Who needs the answer
BQ-1	Which customer segments drove net sales growth this period?	quarterly segment investment allocation	sales-leadership, sales-operations
BQ-2	Which products and regions are growing or declining?	range and territory planning	sales-leadership, merchandising
BQ-3	What makes up a given period's net sales figure?	variance investigation and month-end reconciliation	sales-operations, finance

3 What you need to see

Which outputs do you need: a dashboard, report, extract, API or dataset? Which figures, broken down by what, and which details?

ID	Type	Figures	Broken down by	Details shown	For whom, how often	Req. IDs
OUT-1	dashboard	net sales, units sold	customer segment, product category, region, month	customer segment, product category, region, month		R-1, R-7
OUT-2	extract	net sales, units sold		product category, region, month	external analytics partner, monthly	R-13
OUT-3	report	net sales, units sold		order, order line, order date, customer, customer segment, product, product category, region, order status		R-2, R-8

4 Level of detail

Finest level of detail

What is the finest level you need to drill down to? For example "an individual line on a customer order".

An individual line on a customer order

What makes each one distinct

Could two records ever describe the same thing? If so, which one counts?

Each line on each order counts once, at its latest amended values

5 When values change

If a value such as a customer's segment or a product's category changes, should past figures follow the change or stay as they were?

ID	What can change	Should past figures follow the change or stay as they were? Why?
HB-1	Customer segment	Stay as they were. Past sales keep the segment that applied on the sale date.
HB-2	Product category	Stay as they were, so category trends remain comparable over time.
HB-3	Region	Stay as they were. Past sales stay with the region that applied on the sale date.

6 Timing and volume

How fresh

How up to date must the figures be? For example "hourly during the working day".

Hourly during the working day

Why

Which decision depends on that freshness? What goes wrong if the figures are late?

Leads are reallocated through the day; a stale picture causes duplicate outreach

Users

Roughly how many people will use it, and how often?

About 120 people, several times daily

Volume

Roughly how many records arrive on a busy day?

Roughly 40,000 order lines per day

7 Exceptions

What should happen with cancellations, refunds, amendments and late corrections? One per line.

Cancelled order lines remain visible but do not contribute to net sales
 Amendments replace prior values; each line counts once at its latest values
 Corrections within 90 days restate the period; later corrections do not

8 Bad data**Unusable record**

What would make a record unusable to you?

No customer recorded, or a negative quantity

When bad data arrives

- ☒ Stop and alert - do not publish
- ☐ Publish the good records and report the bad ones
- ☐ Publish everything and flag the bad records

9 Sources

Which systems do you believe hold this data, and which one is the authority?

System	What it holds	Is it the authority?
ora_local	orders, order lines, customers, products, sales reps	System of record for sales

10 Protection and access**Sensitivity**

Your organisation's classification, for example Internal or Confidential.

INTERNAL-COMMERCIAL

Where the data must stay

A country or jurisdiction, for example "United States".

United States

Details some users must not see

For example customer contact details.

Customer contact details

What those users may still see

Customer identity, customer segment

Who may see the data

sales-leadership, sales-operations, finance, data-analytics

Readers outside the organisation

Does anyone outside the organisation need this data? Who, and how may they receive it?

External analytics partner: must not be granted internal system access

11 Agreement with other teams and totals

Must these figures agree with another team's figures? Can they be added up across time, regions and other breakdowns?

ID	Team	Must agree on
AG-1	Finance	Net sales / revenue for a period
AG-2	Merchandising	Product category definitions

Can be added up across

For example days, months, regions and categories.

Days, months, regions, categories, segments

12 Requirements and acceptance examples

One requirement for each behaviour you need, written as "Users SHALL ..." or "Figures SHALL ...". Give at least one worked example of a correct answer: GIVEN a situation, WHEN someone does something, THEN what they should see.

R-1 Segment performance

Users SHALL be able to see net sales by customer segment, product category and region, for any period.

AX-1 · Quarterly segment review

GIVEN	sales recorded in two different quarters
WHEN	a manager asks which customer segments grew net sales between them
THEN	they get net sales per segment for both quarters, worked out the same way

R-2 Drill to the individual line

Users SHALL be able to drill from any total down to the individual line on a customer order that contributed to it.

AX-2 · Explaining a spike

GIVEN	a region shows an unexpected jump in March
WHEN	the user drills into the March figure for that region
THEN	they see the individual order lines, and those lines add up to the figure

R-3 Each order line counted once

Every line on a customer order SHALL be counted exactly once, however many times it was amended.

AX-3 · A line amended twice

GIVEN	a line is amended on Monday and again on Tuesday
WHEN	net sales are reported
THEN	the line contributes once, at Tuesday's values

R-4 Sales reflect the segment at the time of sale

When a customer moves between segments or regions, sales already recorded SHALL continue to be reported under the segment and region that applied on the date of the sale.

AX-4 · Customer re-segmented after a sale

GIVEN	a customer is "SMB" in March and is reclassified "Enterprise" in June
WHEN	March and June sales are reported
THEN	March sales are still reported under "SMB"
AND	June sales are reported under "Enterprise"

R-5 Agreement with Finance

Net sales figures SHALL reconcile with the revenue figures Finance reports for the same period. Where the two differ, the difference SHALL be explainable.

AX-5 · Month-end reconciliation

GIVEN	Finance reports a March revenue total
WHEN	net sales for March are compared with it
THEN	the two reconcile, or the variance is explained and accepted by Finance

R-6 Agreement with the product range

Product categories SHALL match the product range as Merchandising defines it, so that category totals agree across teams. A product that is recategorised SHALL keep its earlier category for earlier sales.

AX-7 · A product recategorised

GIVEN	a product sold in March is moved to a different category in June
WHEN	March and June sales are reported by category
THEN	March sales stay under the old category and June sales appear under the new one

AX-8 · Categories confirmed by Merchandising

GIVEN	the list of product categories used in the figures
WHEN	Merchandising reviews it against their product range
THEN	Merchandising confirms the categories match

R-7 Figures can be totalled

Net sales SHALL be able to be added up across days, months, regions, categories and segments without double counting.

AX-9 · Months add up to the year

GIVEN	monthly net sales for every region, category and segment
WHEN	they are added together
THEN	the total equals net sales counted directly from the individual order lines

R-8 Cancelled lines visible but not counted

Cancelled order lines SHALL remain visible for investigation, and SHALL NOT contribute to net sales.

AX-6 · A cancelled line

GIVEN	a line is cancelled in April
WHEN	April is reported
THEN	the line is visible in April's detail, marked as cancelled
AND	it is excluded from April's net sales total

R-9 Late corrections restate the period

Corrections to a sale arriving within 90 days SHALL restate the affected period. Corrections after 90 days SHALL NOT change published figures.

AX-10 · Corrections inside and outside the window

GIVEN	one sale corrected 30 days after it was made and another corrected 120 days after
WHEN	figures are next refreshed
THEN	the first correction changes its period's figures and the second does not

R-10 Hourly availability during the working day

Sales SHALL be available hourly during the working day. Justification: Sales Operations reallocate leads through the day, and a stale picture causes duplicate customer outreach.

AX-11 · Figures are at most an hour behind

GIVEN	it is a working day between 08:00 and 18:00 Perth time
WHEN	a user looks at the figures
THEN	they include sales recorded up to about an hour earlier
AND	the team is alerted if they fall further behind

R-11 Incomplete sales must not be published

A sale with no customer recorded, or a negative quantity, is unusable. Publication SHALL stop and alert rather than publish partial figures.

AX-12 · A sale with no customer

GIVEN	a new order line arrives with no customer recorded
WHEN	the figures are refreshed
THEN	the previously published figures stay as they were
AND	the team is alerted and can see the unusable line and the reason

R-12 Analysts must not see customer contact details

Customer contact details SHALL NOT be visible to general analyst users, though the customer's identity and segment SHALL be.

AX-13 · An analyst looks up a customer

GIVEN a general analyst
WHEN they look at a customer's details
THEN they see the customer's name and segment
AND the email address and phone number are hidden

R-13 Monthly extract for the analytics partner

An external analytics partner SHALL receive a monthly extract of net sales by month, product category and region. They are outside our organisation and SHALL NOT be granted access to internal systems.

AX-14 · The partner receives a closed month

GIVEN a month has closed
WHEN the monthly extract is shared with the partner
THEN they receive that month's figures without customer-level detail
AND they have no access to any internal system

13 Out of scope

What is explicitly out of scope? Saying so now avoids surprises later.

Forecasting and pipeline reporting
 Margin, cost and profitability analysis
 Commission calculation

14 Open questions

Anything not yet decided. Give each question an owner and a due date, and say what we assume if work starts before it is answered.

ID	Question	Owner	Due	What we assume meanwhile	What it affects
None.					

Approval

The business owner approves the BRD. Teams whose figures must agree with these (see Agreement with other teams) should sign too.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Business owner	Sales Operations		
Data steward	Data Analytics		

Next: The data team records the approved BRD in the repository and checks it is complete (gate G0). They then write the technical design (TDD) and explain it back to you in plain words. You sign that explanation before anything is built (gate G1).

For the data team: where each answer goes

Record the approved document in the repository with the `author-brd` skill, as `openspec/specs/products/<domain>/<product>/brd/spec.md` and `brd.yaml`. Put the use case on the Purpose line, for example `**Use case:** UC-SALES-001`. Then run `dpf brd validate <product>` (gate G0) and take any gaps back to the business.

Section	Rubric group	Recorded in
Change history	-	<code>brd.yaml: changelog</code>
1. Purpose	-	<code>spec.md: Purpose</code>
2. Business questions	A	<code>brd.yaml: business_questions</code>
3. What you need to see	B	<code>brd.yaml: required_outputs</code>
4. Level of detail	C	<code>brd.yaml: level_of_detail</code>
5. When values change	D	<code>brd.yaml: history_behaviour</code>
6. Timing and volume	E	<code>brd.yaml: timeliness</code>
7. Exceptions	F	<code>brd.yaml: exceptions</code>
8. Bad data	G	<code>brd.yaml: fitness</code>
9. Sources	H	<code>brd.yaml: sources_believed</code>
10. Protection and access	I	<code>brd.yaml: sensitivity, residency, protection, external_readers</code>
11. Agreement with other teams and totals	-	<code>brd.yaml: agreement_with_other_teams, totalling</code>
12. Requirements and acceptance examples	J	<code>spec.md: one Requirement per R-n, one Scenario per AX-n</code>
13. Out of scope	K	<code>brd.yaml: non_goals; spec.md: Scope</code>
14. Open questions	-	<code>brd.yaml: open_questions; spec.md: Open questions</code>